FRONT · SIDE 1 OF 2

Set Up Sidekick

Sidekick listens with you. After each transmission it decides whether **your station** should speak and **drafts** exactly what it would say: a check-in, an acknowledgement, a short answer. **It drafts only** until you switch Send on (see the checklist below): you read the draft and decide.

A · THE XAI KEY (optional: without it Sidekick uses its offline rules)

1. **Create a key** at `console.x.ai` → API Keys → Create API Key
   Add a little credit. Sidekick asks the model only on its turns, about 1–4 times a net (well under a cent each). ▶ Hear it costs a little per clip.
2. Settings → **Station agent** → paste the key → Save
   It is kept on this PC only, never shown again and never sent anywhere but xAI.

B · TURN IT ON

3. Settings → **Station agent** → tick **Enable the station agent**, then fill in:

On-air name	Said after your call (default **Sidekick**). Not a phonetic word, number or procedure word (Echo, Portable, Break)
Your first name	Sidekick names you as its control operator
Your check-in line	What it says to check in, e.g. *"This is W9XYZ, Sam, Springfield, no traffic"*
License class	It never drafts outside your phone privileges
Your region	Your state (and county). It answers a roll call by place (*"Stations Colorado, check in now"*) **only** for your region; left empty, never

4. On each radio's card: **Sidekick** Off → Draft
   Off by default on every radio. Its card appears at the top of that radio's column.
5. **Nets where it must not check in** (members-, mobiles- or traffic-only): Nets → the net → **Sidekick on this net** → **Never checks in**
6. **Its voice** (optional): Settings → **Sidekick's voice** → pick one, press ▶
   Plays in this browser only, never on a radio. Without a key or internet, the PC's own voice is used.

Draft only is the default. A radio's PTT stays off until **you** allow it. **Before the first Send, once, into a dummy load: 1** Radios… → **Transmit**: how it keys, **Audio out**, tick **Allow transmitting**, Save. **2** Tick **a dummy load is connected**, press **Tone + ID**: set **Drive level** until deviation is right (about 3 kHz on FM; SSB: ALC just touching), Save. **3 Phrase + ID**: check your call and the audio. **4** Radio card: Sidekick Send . You stay at the PC; **Esc** stops any transmission.

Every draft is checked in code against FCC Part 97 before you see it: your call at the end and every 10 minutes (§97.119), says it is an automated assistant and names you (§97.113), no music, codes or business, no relayed messages (§97.115), silent during emergency or priority traffic (§97.101), inside your privileges (§97.301/305). A draft that fails shows **Would not send** with the rule.

Turn over → side 2: On a Net

BACK · SIDE 2 OF 2

Sidekick on a Net

THE YOUR TURN CHIP (top of Sidekick's card on each radio)

Listening	Not its turn; the reason is shown (*"check-ins called for mobile stations"*)
Check-ins open to you	Net control opened check-ins to a station like yours: a check-in is drafted
CALLED	Someone called your call or Sidekick's name: what they said, and a reply
Answer ready	A question that needed thinking is answered; it waits for net control's *"comments or questions?"*
Checked in ✓	Net control acknowledged you, or your own check-in was heard: it will not check in again

BUTTONS

What would you say now?	A draft for this moment, any time
▶ Hear it 👍 👎	The draft in Sidekick's voice (browser only); rate it
I checked in myself	You checked in on the air: it stops offering a check-in. **Not checked in** undoes it
Mute for this net	Silent until the net ends. **Unmute** undoes it
Chat & prepared...	Private chat; prepared words and talks: **▶ Hear**, approve, **Send now** or **Arm** (*"present the topic"*)
Send	On the air after a 3 s countdown, you at the PC; **Esc** stops

WHEN IT SPEAKS, AND WHEN IT STAYS QUIET

1. **Checks in** when check-ins are open to all, to your region, or to *"anyone with or without traffic"*
2. **Stays quiet** for traffic-only, maritime, mobile, member or EOC calls; *"before I start taking check-ins"*; a bare *"please call now"* whose start was not heard; anyone else's roll call by place
3. **Silent on** *"break break"*, emergency or priority traffic, on every net, unless net control calls you

WHEN SOMETHING LOOKS WRONG

No Sidekick on a radio	Settings → Enable the station agent; then **Draft** on that radio's card
Never answers a roll call	Set **Your region** (Settings → Station agent)
Wants to check in again	Press **I checked in myself**
Amber Offline rules	No key or no internet: it checks in and acknowledges, no answers
Would not send	A Part 97 check stopped it: the rule is shown. Nothing to do
Wrong turn	👎 it: the ratings show what to fix (a net can be replayed: `tools.sidekick_replay`)

Part of HAM Sidekick Station (MIT License). Sidekick transmits only in Send mode, on a radio you allowed, with you at the PC. Drafts stay on this PC (`data\agent_drafts.jsonl`).